

On the Kaplan–Meier Plateau in Recurrent Gap-Time Data

Jacob Spear

September 26, 2026

Abstract

We show that the Kaplan–Meier estimator applied to inter-visit gap times converges to $1/\bar{v}$, where $\bar{v}$ is the mean number of visits per customer, regardless of the underlying churn dynamics. This makes it unsuitable for estimating cure fractions in recurrent-event settings.

1 Introduction